RECIPE CARDS

Recipe cards

Every recipe from the site on one printable page each, with a QR code to the full recipe.



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How to use these cards

Each page is a short version of one web recipe. Page numbers are printed at the bottom of every card.

When is the trigger. **Only if** lists the conditions. **Do** is the action. **Stop** is what ends it.

Scan the QR code, or type the short link, for the full recipe with setup notes, failure modes, and device options.

Devices are examples of what fits the job, not requirements. Any device that does the same job and works with your hub is fine. Local options like Z-Wave, Zigbee, Matter over Thread, and HomeKit keep working when the internet is down.

Test every rule before you rely on it. Safety devices such as smoke, CO, and leak alarms must keep working without automation.

SMART LIGHTING

1 Automate outdoor lights at dusk

A platform-neutral outdoor-lighting recipe that follows sunset, avoids unnecessary overnight runtime, and keeps physical control available.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Sunset occurs, with an optional offset if the property becomes dark earlier or later.
Only if	The outdoor-lighting schedule is enabled. Seasonal lights also require their seasonal toggle to be on.
Do	Turn on the selected outdoor lights.
Stop	Sunrise or the chosen off time turns the lights off.

Tip: Group lights by job: safety, path, decorative, and seasonal.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/outdoor-night-lights.html

SMART LIGHTING

2 Bathroom night-light automation

A local-first bathroom night-light recipe that uses motion, low brightness, and a reliable wall-switch fallback.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Bathroom or entry motion is detected.
Only if	Night mode is active or it is within your chosen night window, and optionally the room is dark enough.
Do	Turn on the bathroom light at 10 percent. Set a warm color temperature only if the light supports it.
Stop	New motion cancels the shutoff. A manual wall-switch change wins.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/bathroom-night-light.html

SMART LIGHTING

3 Control lights with a wireless button or linked switch

Let a physical button, remote, or smart switch control other lights while every room keeps an understandable manual fallback.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A distinct button press, remote action, or scene event.
Only if	The control is available, the command is allowed for the current time or mode, and no manual override is active.
Do	Send an explicit on, off, dim, or scene command to the selected lights.
Stop	The command completes once the target lights report their expected state, or the platform reports that confirmation is unavailable.

Tip: Choose one narrow job, such as turning off the downstairs lights from the bedroom.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/wireless-button-linked-lights.html

SMART LIGHTING

4 Garage lights that follow doors, motion, and the TV

Garage lights turn on when a garage door opens or someone moves, stay on while the space is in use, dim for movies on the garage TV, and turn off only when the garage is really empty.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A garage door opening, motion, or a change in the TV's power draw.
Only if	Lights only turn on if they were off. Turning off needs all three "empty" signals at the same time.
Do	80% for normal use, 25% for movies, off when empty.
Stop	All three empty signals together.

Tip: Measure the TV's power draw when off, in standby, on a menu, and playing a movie. Set the thresholds from real numbers.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/garage-lights-doors-motion-tv.html

SMART LIGHTING

5 Office lights that stay on while you work

Office lights turn on with motion at a level that fits the time of day, and stay on while you sit still because the monitor's power draw shows someone is at the desk.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Office motion, the monitor's power, or the lights turning off.
Only if	Lights only turn on if they were off.
Do	Set the lights, start or pause the music.
Stop	Both "empty" signals together turn off the lights.

Tip: In Windows power settings, set the screen to turn off after a short idle time.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/office-motion-lights.html

SMART LIGHTING

6 Set up gradual wake-up lighting

A platform-neutral recipe that gradually brightens a bedroom light before a set wake time, simulating a sunrise instead of a jarring alarm.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A fixed time before the desired wake time, such as 30 minutes prior.
Only if	The day matches the intended schedule, such as weekdays only, and any vacation or skip setting is off.
Do	Set the light to a low starting brightness, then gradually raise it toward full brightness over the chosen duration.
Stop	The transition ends once it reaches full brightness, or is cancelled by a manual override.

Tip: Decide on the wake time and the transition length, then calculate the start time by subtracting the two, for example 6:00 AM start for a 6:30 AM wake time with a 30 minute transition.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/wake-up-lights.html

SMART LIGHTING

7 Turn lights off after motion stops

A conservative motion-lighting off recipe that respects still occupants, manual wall-switch choices, and local-first control.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The room sensor reports no motion for the chosen timeout.
Only if	The light was turned on by this automation, no other room sensor is active, and no manual override is active.
Do	Turn the light off.
Stop	New motion, another active sensor, or a manual wall-switch change cancels the shutoff.

Tip: Quick access spaces: One to two minutes can work for a closet or hallway.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/lights-off-after-motion.html

SMART LIGHTING

8 Turn lights on when a door opens

A local-first contact-sensor lighting recipe for closets, pantries, and utility rooms that keeps the familiar wall switch usable.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The contact sensor changes from closed to open.
Only if	The space is dark enough, or it is within the hours when automatic light makes sense.
Do	Turn on the light at the desired brightness.
Stop	A manual wall-switch change is an explicit choice and should not be immediately reversed.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/toggle-lights-door.html

SMART LIGHTING

9 Turn lights on with motion sensors

A local-first motion-lighting recipe for turning lights on when someone enters, while keeping the familiar wall switch in control.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The entry sensor changes from clear to motion detected.
Only if	The room is dark enough, or it is within the hours you want automatic light.
Do	Turn on the light. Use a dim level at night if the light supports it.
Stop	A manual wall-switch change should prevent the off recipe from undoing the person's choice.

Tip: Daytime: Leave the light off when daylight is sufficient.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/lights-on-motion.html

SMART LIGHTING

10 Turn off closet lights on door close

A platform-neutral follow-up to door-triggered lighting that turns off only the light the automation turned on and cancels when the door reopens.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The contact sensor changes from open to closed.
Only if	The paired door-open recipe turned this light on, the sensor remains available, and no manual light change has canceled automation ownership.
Do	Start a short off delay, then turn off the light and clear the ownership marker.
Stop	The light turns off, the door reopens, or a person changes the light manually.

Tip: Complete and test the door-open lighting recipe first.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/disable-on-door-close.html

SMART LIGHTING

11 Video call lighting button

One button press turns on a warm backlight behind you, dims the overhead lights, and pauses the music for a video call, then puts everything back when the call ends.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A button press toggles the backlight. The backlight turning on or off drives everything else.
Only if	After the call, music resumes only if it was playing when the call started.
Do	Dim or restore the ceiling lights, pause or resume the office speaker.
Stop	Turning the backlight off ends call mode.

Tip: Put the button where you can reach it from your chair. You will press it with a call already ringing.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/video-call-lighting-button.html

SMART LIGHTING

12 Welcome arrivals with path lighting

Make the final steps to the door easier after dark while leaving the lock and manually controlled lights alone.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A pending-arrival state is followed by a tested physical entry signal within a short confirmation window.
Only if	It is dark, the home was Away before the candidate arrival, no safety mode blocks the action, and the target light is not already on.
Do	Turn on the approved entry or path light and mark only that light as owned by this welcome run.
Stop	The pending arrival expires without a physical signal, the person returns to Away, or a manual light change cancels ownership.

Tip: Complete the safe arrival routine and use its Home, Away, and pending-arrival states.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/lighting/driveway-welcome-wave.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

13 Alert when a door is left unlocked

Keep an unlocked exterior door visible, check locks at bedtime, and add automatic locking only with current door and lock feedback.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A lock remains unlocked past a delay, or the household intentionally starts the bedtime check.
Only if	The lock report is current, no approved temporary-unlocked period is active, and any automatic lock command has a confirmed closed-door state.
Do	Create persistent status, send one named notification, and at bedtime summarize every lock needing attention.
Stop	Clear the incident only when the lock reports locked or a person explicitly acknowledges an unresolved manual check.

Tip: Name each lock and door by location.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/door-unlocked-bedtime-check.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

14 Dog-bark intrusion deterrent

A platform-neutral recipe that plays a dog barking sound through a speaker when motion is detected while away, as a supplementary deterrent layer.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A motion sensor covering an entry point detects movement.
Only if	The home is in Away mode and, optionally, the time is within a defined nighttime window.
Do	Play a dog barking audio clip on a nearby speaker at a moderate volume, and send a notification.
Stop	A cooldown period, such as several minutes, prevents repeat playback from continued motion in the same area.

Tip: Confirm the platform can play a specific audio file or sound effect on the target speaker; test this manually before wiring it into an automation.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/fake-dog-deterrent.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

15 Garage door left-open alerts

A platform-neutral recipe that alerts when a garage door has been left open too long. Alerting only; closing stays manual or with equipment built for it.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The garage door sensor reports "open" and stays in that state for a set duration, such as 10 minutes.
Only if	The door is still open at the time the duration elapses.
Do	Send a notification stating how long the door has been open.
Stop	The door being closed manually clears the alert.

Tip: Install a tilt sensor on the garage door, or confirm an existing smart garage controller already reports open and closed state to the platform.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/garage-door-notification.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

16 Safer automatic garage closing

Alert first, keep people in control, and allow unattended closing only through equipment designed for it with working entrapment protection and warnings.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The door remains open longer than the household expects.
Only if	The position sensor is recent and available.
Do	Send a persistent alert naming the door and its reported state.
Stop	The position sensor reports closed after a person closes it, or a person explicitly dismisses the reminder.

Tip: Test the opener, wall control, remote, photo-eyes, auto-reverse, audible warning, and visual warning according to manufacturer instructions.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/garage-auto-close.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

17 Set a persistent cooking reminder

Keep a cooking reminder visible until someone clears it, using a deliberate timer or approved appliance status signal.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A person deliberately starts Cooking mode or an approved appliance signal reports active cooking.
Only if	Record which signal started the reminder. Do not require missing motion or Away mode.
Do	Start a visible timer and send a persistent reminder when the chosen interval expires.
Stop	A person checks the appliance controls and clears the reminder.

Tip: Put a physical timer or one-tap Cooking control next to the normal cooking workflow.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/stove-left-on-alert.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

18 Supplemental fire evacuation support

A conservative fire-response recipe that treats listed smoke alarms as primary, turns on useful lighting immediately, and never infers that a fire is over.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A supported alarm integration reports smoke or carbon monoxide.
Only if	None. Do not add mode, time, occupancy, or multi-sensor confirmation conditions.
Do	Turn on fixed path and exterior lights that are safe to operate, then send a supplemental alert naming the reported alarm.
Stop	A responsible person manually resets the supplemental response after emergency services or a qualified person says it is safe.

Tip: Install, place, interconnect, test, and replace alarms according to local requirements and manufacturer instructions.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/fire-safety.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

19 Turn on away lights to look occupied

A platform-neutral recipe that turns on a few strategic lights while away to make the home look occupied, without an unnatural all-lights-on pattern.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The home enters Away mode, or the time reaches sunset while already in Away mode.
Only if	The home is currently in Away mode, and the time is between sunset and a set cutoff, such as 11:00 PM.
Do	Turn on the selected away lights, ideally as a single scene rather than individually.
Stop	The cutoff time is reached, or the home leaves Away mode because someone returns.

Tip: Choose two or three lights that a person home alone would realistically use, such as a living room lamp and one bedroom light; avoid lighting every room.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/away-lights.html

SAFETY AND SECURITY

20 Water leak detection alerts

A platform-neutral leak recipe that identifies the wet sensor, alerts the household immediately, and adds automatic water shutoff only after verified testing.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Any leak sensor reports wet.
Only if	None for the first alert. Leak alerts run in Home, Away, Night, and guest modes.
Do	Send a persistent high-priority notification naming the sensor and location, alert at least two responsible people, and turn on a local indicator if it is safe and useful.
Stop	A person inspects the source, stops the water if necessary, and manually clears the incident.

Tip: Name each sensor for the response location, such as "Laundry supply hoses" instead of "Leak sensor 3."

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/security/water-leak-response.html

APPLIANCE

21 Automate morning coffee safely

Prepare the coffee maker the night before and get a clear morning result without wondering whether it was actually made ready.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Evening preparation time or the household bedtime routine.
Only if	None for the reminder.
Do	Remind a person to load the machine, set its approved delayed-brew controls, and deliberately mark Ready for morning.
Stop	A person cancels Ready or the morning window ends.

Tip: Read the coffee maker's instructions for delayed brew, auto-off, cleaning, water level, basket, and carafe placement.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/appliances/coffee-maker-morning.html

APPLIANCE

22 Dishwasher finished notification

Learn the dishwasher's power or vibration pattern and send one reliable completion alert without controlling appliance power.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Measured power or vibration stays above the dishwasher's calibrated running threshold long enough to prove a cycle started.
Only if	Monitoring data is current and the dishwasher was not already marked as running.
Do	Mark the dishwasher as running and clear any previous waiting-dishes state.
Stop	Mark the cycle finished, send one notification, and set a waiting-dishes state.

Tip: Check the dishwasher manual and nameplate before connecting any inline monitoring device.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/appliances/dishwasher-done-notification.html

APPLIANCE

23 Fridge and freezer door alerts

Alert the household when a fridge or freezer door stays open, using a shorter delay for the freezer and safe handling of missing data.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The fridge or freezer door sensor reports open.
Only if	The sensor is available and reporting current data.
Do	Start a timer specific to that appliance.
Stop	The door closes before the delay elapses, which cancels the alert.

Tip: Mount the sensor body on the door frame and the magnet on the door edge, where the gap stays smallest when closed.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/appliances/fridge-door-alert.html

APPLIANCE

24 Get notified when the dryer finishes

A platform-neutral laundry recipe that detects sustained dryer vibration and sends one completion alert without controlling appliance power.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Vibration remains active long enough to prove the dryer started.
Only if	The sensor is available and the dryer was not already marked as running.
Do	Mark the dryer as running and clear any previous waiting-laundry state.
Stop	Mark the cycle finished, send one notification, and set a waiting-laundry state.

Tip: Find a fixed exterior panel that remains cool and does not block vents, labels, controls, or service access.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/appliances/dryer-done-notification.html

APPLIANCE

25 Get notified when the washer finishes

A platform-neutral laundry recipe that learns the washer's power pattern and sends one reliable completion alert without controlling appliance power.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Measured power stays above the washer's calibrated running threshold long enough to prove a cycle started.
Only if	Monitoring data is current and the washer was not already marked as running.
Do	Mark the washer as running and clear any previous waiting-laundry state.
Stop	Mark the cycle finished, send one notification, and set a waiting-laundry state.

Tip: Check the washer manual and nameplate before connecting any inline monitoring device.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/appliances/washer-done-notification.html

APPLIANCE

26 Start the vacuum when everyone leaves

A platform-neutral recipe that starts a robot vacuum only after a tested presence signal confirms the home is empty, and only during a daytime window.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The tested presence signal reports the home as empty.
Only if	The time is within the chosen daytime window, Guest mode is off, and the vacuum has not already run today.
Do	Wait briefly to confirm the departure is real, then start the vacuum's existing cleaning cycle.
Stop	The vacuum finishes, or the tested presence signal reports that someone returned; in either case, send it back to its dock.

Tip: Confirm the presence signal against at least a week of real household comings and goings before using it to start anything.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/appliances/robot-vacuum-auto-start.html

APPLIANCE

27 Vacuum while the house is empty

A platform-neutral recipe that starts a robot vacuum only after confirming the home is empty and sends it back to the dock the moment anyone returns.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The tested presence signal reports the home as empty during the chosen daytime window.
Only if	The vacuum has not already completed a cycle today.
Do	Wait briefly to confirm the departure is real, then start cleaning.
Stop	As soon as the presence signal reports anyone home, send the vacuum back to its dock immediately, whether or not the room it was cleaning is finished.

Tip: Confirm the presence signal against a week of real comings and goings for every household member before using it here.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/appliances/vacuum-when-empty.html

CLIMATE AND COMFORT

28 Automate a bathroom exhaust fan

Run the bathroom fan when a shower starts and turn it off once the steam clears, with nothing to remember and no fan left running all morning.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The shower light turns on, or bathroom humidity rises above its calibrated baseline.
Only if	The time falls within the household's normal waking hours, unless overnight ventilation is specifically wanted.
Do	Turn on the bathroom fan.
Stop	The light turns off, or humidity drops back to baseline, for the confirmation period.

Tip: Choose one primary trigger, either the shower light or a humidity sensor, and treat the other as a backup rather than combining them in a way that confuses troubleshooting.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/climate/fan-shower.html

CLIMATE AND COMFORT

29 Automate an indoor air purifier

A platform-neutral recipe that runs a plug-controlled air purifier when an air quality sensor reports a sustained drop, and stops nagging once the air clears.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The air quality sensor reports an unhealthy reading.
Only if	The sensor is available and the reading has held at an unhealthy level for several minutes.
Do	Turn on the purifier, choosing a higher speed for a worse reading if the purifier supports it.
Stop	Turn off the purifier once the air has stayed clear through the confirmation period.

Tip: Place the sensor away from the kitchen, a litter box, or other constant local sources so it reflects the room's general air rather than one corner.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/climate/air-quality-purifier.html

CLIMATE AND COMFORT

30 Automate blinds at sunrise and sunset

Open motorized blinds near sunrise and close them near sunset while preserving privacy, bedtime limits, and physical control.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Sunrise, with a comfortable offset, or sunset.
Only if	The blind schedule is enabled. A bedroom may also require the household to be awake before opening.
Do	Open blinds after the sunrise offset. Close them at sunset, or no later than a fixed bedtime for privacy-sensitive rooms.
Stop	The blinds reach their commanded position.

Tip: Group blinds by job: privacy-sensitive, general living space, and solar-gain windows.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/climate/blinds-sunset-sunrise.html

CLIMATE AND COMFORT

31 Cold-room temperature alerts

Get an alert before a cold room leaves its safe temperature range without controlling a portable heater through a general smart plug.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The room remains outside its chosen temperature range, or the sensor stops reporting.
Only if	The reading is recent and the sensor has been compared with a known thermometer.
Do	Send an alert naming the room and show the current reading.
Stop	A person inspects the room and acknowledges the alert.

Tip: Put the sensor away from direct sunlight, supply vents, exterior doors, and the heater itself.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/climate/room-heater-maintain-temp.html

CLIMATE AND COMFORT

32 Limit an IR-controlled mini-split

Send only a capped infrared setpoint. Never trust blaster state, and keep the physical remote.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The room temperature stays outside the band you chose for that mode.
Only if	The reading is recent, the command is inside the hard cap, heat or cool was chosen on purpose, and the physical remote has not been used since the last send.
Do	Send one discrete setpoint code. Prefer a single code that means the mode and temperature together.
Stop	The room is back inside the band, the sensor goes stale, someone uses the remote, or the command would fall outside the cap.

Tip: Write the heat ceiling and the cool floor on a card by the remote, and put the same numbers in the rule. The rule refuses to send anything outside them.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/climate/mini-split-ir-setpoint-limit.html

CLIMATE AND COMFORT

33 Pause HVAC when a window stays open

A platform-neutral climate recipe that pauses HVAC after a window remains open and resumes only when every monitored opening is closed.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Any monitored window or door remains open for two minutes.
Only if	Heating or cooling is active, climate pause is enabled, and no safety condition requires HVAC to continue.
Do	Record that this recipe owns the pause, save the current thermostat mode if the system can do so reliably, pause HVAC, and identify the opening in a notification.
Stop	Every monitored opening has remained closed briefly.

Tip: Start with windows people intentionally leave open. Exclude exterior doors used for quick trips.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/climate/thermostat-windows-open.html

CLIMATE AND COMFORT

34 Safe thermostat auto-away

Use a modest thermostat setback when the home is empty without risking pets, frozen pipes, manual holds, or an unsafe recovery.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The shared house state changes to Away after its confirmation delay.
Only if	Guest or Staying Home is off, no uncertain presence remains, thermostat data is current, and the requested setting is inside approved safety limits.
Do	Apply the approved daily setback and record that this recipe made the change.
Stop	Someone returns, a person selects Home or Guest, a safety boundary is approached, or thermostat data becomes unavailable.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/climate/safe-thermostat-away.html

CLIMATE AND COMFORT

35 Window ventilation notifications

A platform-neutral recipe that compares indoor and outdoor temperature and notifies the household when opening or closing windows would save energy.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The gap between indoor and outdoor temperature crosses a chosen threshold in the useful direction for the current season.
Only if	The gap has held for several minutes, and any tracked windows are currently closed.
Do	Send one notification suggesting windows be opened or closed.
Stop	The notification is sent once; the household decides whether to act on it.

Tip: Confirm both the indoor and outdoor temperature readings are current and reasonably accurate before using them.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/climate/window-notifications.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

36 Get front-door motion alerts

Use an outdoor motion sensor to prompt a quick check when someone or something moves near the entrance, without claiming that every alert is a delivery.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The entrance motion sensor detects movement.
Only if	No motion has already been detected within a short cooldown window, to avoid repeat notifications for the same visit.
Do	Send a phone notification, such as "Motion detected at the front door."
Stop	Not applicable; each motion event is a separate notification, subject to any cooldown.

Tip: Mount a motion sensor rated for the entrance's actual exposure, whether that is a covered porch or a fully exposed area.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/package-delivery-alert.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

37 Home maintenance reminder dashboard

A platform-neutral recipe that tracks recurring home maintenance tasks, such as filter changes, on a shared dashboard instead of relying on memory.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A fixed interval since the task was last marked done, such as every 60 to 90 days for an HVAC filter.
Only if	The task has not already been marked done within that interval.
Do	Mark the dashboard tile for that task as overdue.
Stop	Marking the task done resets the interval and clears the tile.

Tip: List the recurring maintenance tasks worth tracking, along with a rough interval for each one.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/maintenance-reminder-dashboard.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

38 House status check on demand

Press a button and get one push message that sums up the house, with the mode, open windows and doors, the front door lock, air quality, rain, and appliances that are still running.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A button press, a dashboard tile, or a voice command. Nothing triggers it on its own.
Only if	Each line has its own check.
Do	Send one push message.
Stop	The message is sent once per request.

Tip: Group the window sensors by floor, so the message can say where the open window is.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/house-status-on-demand.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

39 Kids' teeth-brushing reminder

A platform-neutral recipe that uses a power-monitoring smart plug on an electric toothbrush charger to confirm brushing happened, with a reminder if it did not.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The smart plug's reported power draw drops, indicating the toothbrush was removed from the charger, or a scheduled check runs near a target brushing time.
Only if	A removal has not already been detected within the current brushing window, such as morning or evening.
Do	Log the brushing window as complete when a removal is detected; send a reminder notification if the target time passes without one.
Stop	A detected removal for the current window clears any pending reminder for that window.

Tip: Plug the toothbrush charger into a smart plug that supports power or wattage monitoring, not just basic on/off control.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/teeth-brushing-reminder.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

40 Monitor freezer temperature and outbuilding power

Alert when a freezer warms unexpectedly or a garage or shed may have lost power, while distinguishing temperature, power, and communications failures.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Sustained high temperature, loss of a dedicated powered heartbeat, or stale sensor data.
Only if	The reading is current, the relevant monitoring path is healthy enough to evaluate, and the condition lasts long enough to reject a brief fluctuation.
Do	Send a persistent alert naming the freezer or building, current reading, threshold duration, and what remains unknown.
Stop	Keep the incident visible until a person inspects the freezer or power source and acknowledges it.

Tip: Name each freezer and monitored building by location.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/freezer-temperature-power-loss.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

41 Set a nursery quiet mode

Let a caregiver explicitly request nursery quiet mode while urgent safety alerts, manual controls, and normal emergency behavior remain active.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A caregiver deliberately selects Quiet.
Only if	None based on inferred sleep, motion, sound, or device power.
Do	Use the household's chosen dim lighting and lower only optional chimes or media.
Stop	A caregiver selects Normal.

Tip: Name the state Nursery Quiet, not Baby sleeping.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/baby-sleep-mode.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

42 Set up a garbage day reminder tile

A platform-neutral recipe that turns a dashboard tile red before garbage day and green again once the task is marked done.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A fixed time the evening before collection, such as 6:00 PM on the day before pickup.
Only if	None required for the basic version; a calendar check can be added if the collection schedule varies.
Do	Turn on the virtual switch tied to the dashboard tile, which turns the tile red.
Stop	Tapping the tile, or an optional auto-reset the morning after collection, turns the virtual switch off again.

Tip: Create a virtual switch or variable to represent the reminder's state.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/garbage-day-reminder.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

43 Set up a pet feeding reminder

A platform-neutral recipe that uses a smart button or repurposed sensor to track and remind about pet feeding times.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The feeding button is pressed, or a scheduled check runs to see how long it has been since the last press.
Only if	More time has passed than the expected feeding interval, such as 8 to 12 hours.
Do	Send a reminder notification if feeding has not been logged within the expected window; reset the "last fed" timestamp when the button is pressed.
Stop	Pressing the feeding button clears the reminder and resets the timer.

Tip: Choose a smart button, or repurpose a contact sensor, as the physical feeding-log trigger, placed somewhere convenient near the feeding area.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/pet-feeding-reminder.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

44 Shared whole-home music controls

Stop switching between manufacturer apps just to pause a speaker or change its volume in another room.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A dashboard tile is tapped, such as play, pause, or a volume adjustment.
Only if	The targeted speaker is online and reachable by the platform.
Do	Send the corresponding playback or volume command to that speaker.
Stop	Not applicable; each tile press is a separate command.

Tip: Confirm the platform already integrates with each speaker brand in use; this recipe only adds a dashboard layer on top of that integration.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/music-controls.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

45 Smart home low-battery alerts

A platform-neutral recipe that notifies when a battery-powered sensor, lock, or button drops below a set level, before it fails silently.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A monitored device's battery level drops below its set threshold, or reports a "low battery" state.
Only if	The device has not already been flagged within the last several days, to avoid repeat alerts for the same drop.
Do	Send a notification naming the device and its battery level.
Stop	The alert resets once the battery is replaced and reports a normal level again.

Tip: Confirm which devices actually report battery data in the platform; some devices only expose a simple low-battery flag rather than a percentage.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/low-battery-alerts.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

46 Smart home status tiles

A platform-neutral recipe that replaces one-time push notifications with persistent dashboard tiles for household status information.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The underlying condition for a given tile changes, such as a scheduled reminder becoming due.
Only if	None beyond the specific condition each tile is tracking.
Do	Update the tile's virtual switch or variable to reflect the new state, changing its color or label on the dashboard.
Stop	The condition being tracked resolves, either automatically or by a household member marking it done.

Tip: Identify recurring status information currently sent as one-time notifications that would work better as a persistent tile.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/status-tiles.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

47 Spoken school morning reminders

On school days, a kitchen speaker announces when it is time to brush teeth and put on shoes, then goes back to the music that was playing.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Two fixed times in the morning.
Only if	Monday through Friday, and the home mode is Home.
Do	A spoken announcement at a fixed volume that interrupts and then resumes music.
Stop	Each reminder plays once.

Tip: Pick the times by working backward from when you need to leave. Our two reminders are five minutes apart.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/school-morning-reminders.html

NOTIFICATION AND ALERT

48 Traditional doorbell phone alerts

A platform-neutral recipe that wires a contact sensor in parallel with an existing wired doorbell chime so ringing it sends a phone notification.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The contact sensor changes state when the doorbell press closes its dry terminals.
Only if	None; every press should notify.
Do	Send a phone notification, such as "Someone is at the front door."
Stop	Not applicable; each press is a separate event.

Tip: Turn off power to the doorbell transformer before doing any wiring.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/notifications/doorbell-notification.html

DAILY ROUTINE

49 Build a family-safe bedtime routine

Separate a gentle wind-down from an intentional good-night action while preserving occupied rooms, safety alerts, and manual control.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A scheduled wind-down prompt or an intentional good-night button, phrase, or control.
Only if	The home is occupied, no emergency mode is active, and the selected stage is allowed in the current Home or Guest mode.
Do	For wind-down, gently adjust only approved shared-room lights. For good night, set Night mode, turn off approved unoccupied lights, preserve path lighting, apply an approved climate setting, and report unresolved door or appliance status.
Stop	Complete one pass, report anything needing a person, and do not repeat until Night mode ends.

Tip: List the devices the final routine may change. Leave everything else out.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/daily-routines/bedtime-routine.html

DAILY ROUTINE

50 Guest-friendly smart home mode

A platform-neutral guest mode that keeps lights and physical controls simple, prevents false Away mode, and quiets only non-urgent personal automation.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A host explicitly starts Guest mode and optionally records an expected departure time.
Only if	No emergency mode is active, and the host confirms which rooms or routines the visit affects.
Do	Mark guests present, prevent phone-only Away activation, keep simple lighting and physical controls active, mute non-urgent personal announcements, and pause routines that expose private information or assume resident schedules.
Stop	A host confirms that the visit ended, then normal Home behavior resumes without replaying missed actions.

Tip: Create one Guest-present state with a responsible host and expected end time.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/daily-routines/guest-mode.html

DAILY ROUTINE

51 Manage wall tablets with home modes

Wake, dim, mute, and turn off wall-mounted dashboard tablets when the home mode changes, and let one tablet double as a night guide to the bathroom.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A home mode change, or a bathroom light changing while the mode is Night.
Only if	The bathroom guide behavior only runs in Night mode.
Do	Screen on or off, load the start URL, set brightness, and mute.
Stop	The next mode change sets the tablets to that mode's state.

Tip: Turn on Remote Admin in Fully Kiosk Browser and set a password. The hub talks to the tablet over the local network.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/daily-routines/wall-tablet-modes.html

DAILY ROUTINE

52 Prepare the house when someone arrives

Restore Home mode, light a safe path, and resume normal comfort without treating phone location as proof of identity.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A tracked household member changes from Away to Home.
Only if	The house was actually in Away mode, the arrival remains stable briefly, and this is the first person home.
Do	Set the house to Home, turn on entry or path lights if it is dark, restore the approved thermostat setting, and send a concise status notification.
Stop	The presence signal returns to Away before the confirmation delay ends.

Tip: Make the arrival routine consume the same Home and Away states used by the away-mode recipe.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/daily-routines/unlock-door-arrival.html

DAILY ROUTINE

53 Set away mode when everyone leaves

A conservative, platform-neutral away-mode recipe that verifies the home is empty before changing lights, climate, or security behavior.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The last tracked household member leaves the home area.
Only if	Everyone has remained away for 10 to 15 minutes, Guest or Staying Home mode is off, and no recent indoor activity suggests someone remains.
Do	Set the shared house state to Away, turn off nonessential lights, apply a safe thermostat setback, and notify the household.
Stop	Someone returns, indoor activity appears during the delay, or a person selects Home, Guest, or Staying Home.

Tip: Create one shared state with at least Home, Away, and Guest values.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/daily-routines/away-mode.html

DAILY ROUTINE

54 Start a quiet good-morning routine

A platform-neutral morning routine that starts from an intentional signal, lights only the needed path, and leaves sleeping household members undisturbed.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A person intentionally presses the morning button, uses the morning phrase, or dismisses a verified wake alarm.
Only if	The home is in Night mode, no Guest, Vacation, Away, or safety override is active, and the routine is enabled for that person or schedule.
Do	Change Night to Home, light only the needed route at a gentle level, and restore previously approved morning comfort settings.
Stop	The routine finishes after its one-time actions and cannot run again until the next Night-mode cycle.

Tip: Choose an intentional trigger that works without opening an app.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/daily-routines/morning-routine.html

ENTERTAINMENT

55 Control music with a physical switch

A platform-neutral recipe that uses a wall switch or button to start, stop, or adjust music instead of relying on a voice assistant.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The button is pressed, or the switch changes position.
Only if	None required; an instant response is usually the point.
Do	Toggle playback, or start a specific playlist at a preset volume, on the chosen speaker.
Stop	A second press toggles playback off, or a separate button stops it.

Tip: Confirm the button or switch is paired and reports a press reliably in the platform's automation log before building the automation around it.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/entertainment/music-switch-control.html

ENTERTAINMENT

56 Dim lights when the TV turns on

Dim living-room lights when the TV turns on, then restore them afterward using a tested power or device-status signal.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	Power draw on the TV's smart plug rises above a threshold, or the TV/streaming device reports it is playing.
Only if	The current time is after a chosen hour, such as sunset, if daytime dimming is not wanted.
Do	Save the current light brightness, then dim the living room lights to a low level.
Stop	Power draw drops below a lower threshold, or the TV reports it has stopped, for a couple of minutes.

Tip: If using power monitoring, test the TV's actual wattage in both standby and active playback so the "on" and "off" thresholds are set apart from real values, not guessed.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/entertainment/tv-dim-lights.html

ENTERTAINMENT

57 Play music when a shower starts

A platform-neutral recipe that starts music or a podcast in the bathroom when a shower begins, using a light or door sensor as the trigger.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The bathroom light turns on, or a door sensor reports the shower door opening.
Only if	The current time is within normal waking hours, and the household is not in a sleeping or quiet-hours state.
Do	Start music or the last-used podcast on the bathroom speaker at a preset volume.
Stop	The light stays off, or the door stays closed, for a couple of minutes.

Tip: Choose one trigger, the light switch or a door sensor, and treat the other as an optional backup rather than combining both in a way that is hard to troubleshoot.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/entertainment/shower-music.html

ENTERTAINMENT

58 Play music when arriving home

A platform-neutral recipe that starts music on arrival, using a tested presence signal, to create a consistent welcome-home moment.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	The household's presence state changes from away to home.
Only if	The current time falls within hours the household wants a welcome-home moment, and music is not already playing.
Do	Start the welcome playlist on the main speaker at a preset volume.
Stop	Manual, or a separate automation that stops music after a set duration if desired.

Tip: Confirm the presence signal being used, phone location, lock, or garage sensor, has been tested and works reliably for every regular household member, not just one phone.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/entertainment/welcome-home-music.html

ENTERTAINMENT

59 Set smart-speaker volume presets

Choose a quiet, normal, or loud preset once instead of adjusting each speaker by hand whenever the household changes activities.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A button, voice command, or scheduled time selects a preset (low, medium, or loud).
Only if	None required; the chosen preset applies immediately.
Do	Set every speaker in the group to the percentage defined for that preset.
Stop	Not applicable; a preset simply sets a level rather than starting or stopping something.

Tip: Decide on a small number of presets, such as low, medium, and loud, rather than a long list that becomes hard to remember.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/entertainment/speaker-volume-presets.html

ENTERTAINMENT

60 Set up one-tap pool party mode

A platform-neutral recipe that starts music and lighting for a pool or backyard party with one button press, without touching safety alarms.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A button press, voice command, or dashboard tile for "pool party mode."
Only if	The current time falls within hours the household considers reasonable for outdoor music.
Do	Set outdoor lighting to a party scene, start the party playlist at a set volume, and pause only non-critical outdoor notifications, such as routine motion alerts.
Stop	A separate "end party" trigger, or the automatic timeout, restores normal lighting and stops music.

Tip: Confirm outdoor lighting and the speaker both respond reliably to platform commands before wiring them into a single scene.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/entertainment/pool-party-mode.html

ENTERTAINMENT

61 Whole-home music with favorite station switches

Virtual switches for favorite stations group the downstairs speakers and start a Sonos favorite, and a nightly reset ungroups them and puts every speaker back at a sensible volume.

DEVICES

- See the full recipe for device options.

LOGIC

When	A station switch, a mode change to Home, the stop switch, a mode change to Night or Away, or a reset switch.
Only if	None beyond which switch or mode triggered it.
Do	Group, load a favorite, pause, or reset.
Stop	The stop switch, or the next mode change.

Tip: Save each station as a Sonos favorite first. The automation loads favorites by name or ID, so the favorite has to exist.

Scan for the full recipe

homeautomationcookbook.com/automation/entertainment/sonos-favorite-switches.html

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